

THE TROUSSEAU

Shifting focus from international fashion weeks to domestic buyers, Indian designers are going local and lucrative, while realising that the desi customer is the big king

■ By Kimi Dangor

From London Fashion Week to lehenga cholis for the local brides, from nouveau chic in New York to wedding expositions in Mumbai—fashion's focus has shifted to home shores. Having made a splash at international fashion weeks and amassing foreign clientele, some of India's most fashionably feted labels have turned their gaze eastwards.

From wooing buyers at Browns, in London, to bridal fittings across the country, Kolkata's wonder boy Sabyasachi Mukherjee has partially shifted his focus from international couture crème puff to delve into the domestic market. "I am working on an Indian collection to optimise my sales," he says. To re-acquaint himself with the Indian buyers, the designer has embarked on trunk shows across the country, where he meets clients personally and takes orders. And if sales worth Rs 50 lakh on day one of his Mumbai trunk show are any indication of Mukherjee's local market, he is all set to make a killing.

Cutting quite the same pattern are Mumbai-based designers Falguni & Shane Peacock, who have taken a break from serenading international clients to launch their very first bridal collection for buyers back home. Rocky S, known for his rockstar chic and Bollywood blend, has also decided to give funky corsets and mini-skirts a rest, in pursuit of ghaghra cholis and saris. The designer

recently launched his first-ever couture line with high-end Indian wear. Similarly, Delhi-based designers Gaurav Gupta and Varun Bahl, hitherto known for their avant-garde style, have also jumped on to the trousseau trend mill with a line of saris and festive Indian wear, while newbie designer Nikasha Tawadey is raring to explore the bridal bazaar.

While Rack Space at stores like Le



VARUN BAHL

The look is classic, with reds and pinks ruling the colour palette. Saris are teamed with golden cholis.

